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Git Commit

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What is a Commit?

SHARE

A **commit** is like a save point in your project.

It records a snapshot of your files at a certain time, with a message describing what changed.

You can always go back to a previous commit if you need to.

Here are some key commands for commits:

- `git commit -m "message"` - Commit staged changes with a message
- `git commit -a -m "message"` - Commit all tracked changes (skip staging)
- `git log` - See commit history

Change Platform:
GitHub
Bitbucket
GitLab

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Example

```
[user@localhost] $ git commit -m "First release of Hello World!"
[master (root-commit) 221ec6e] First release of Hello W
 3 files changed, 26 insertions(+)
 create mode 100644 README.md
 create mode 100644 bluestyle.css
 create mode 100644 index.html
```

Always write a clear message so you and others can understand what changed.

REMOVE ADS

Commit All Changes Without Staging (`-a`)

You can skip the staging step for **already tracked files** with `git commit -a -m "message"`.

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Example

```
[user@localhost] $ git commit -a -m "Quick update to README"
[master 123abcd] Quick update to README
 1 file changed, 2 insertions(+)
```

Warning: Skipping the staging step can make you include unwanted changes. Use with care.

Note: `git commit -a` does not work for new/untracked files. You must use `git add <file>` first for new files.

What happens if you try to commit a new file with `-a`?

```
[user@localhost] $ $ git commit -a -m "Try to commit new file"
On branch master

No commits yet

Untracked files:
  (use "git add ..." to include in what will be committ
        index.html

nothing added to commit but untracked files present (us
```

Write Multi-line Commit Messages

If you just type `git commit` (no `-m`), your default editor will open so you can write a detailed, multi-line message:

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Write a short summary on the first line, leave a blank line, then add more details below.

Commit Message Best Practices:

- Keep the first line short (50 characters or less).
- Use the imperative mood (e.g., "Add feature" not "Added feature").
- Leave a blank line after the summary, then add more details if needed.
- Describe *why* the change was made, not just what changed.

Other Useful Commit Options

- **Create an empty commit:**
  `git commit --allow-empty -m "Start project"`
- **Use previous commit message (no editor):**
  `git commit --no-edit`
- **Quickly add staged changes to last commit, keep message:**
  `git commit --amend --no-edit`

Troubleshooting Common Commit Mistakes

- **Forgot to stage a file?**
  If you run `git commit -m "message"` but forgot to `git add` a file, just add it and commit again. Or use `git commit --amend` to add it to your last commit.
- **Typo in your commit message?**
  Use `git commit --amend -m "Corrected message"` to fix the last commit message.
- **Accidentally committed the wrong files?**
  You can use `git reset --soft HEAD~1` to undo the last commit and keep your changes staged.

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Example

```
[user@localhost] $ git log
commit 09f4acd3f8836b7f6fc44ad9e012f82faf861803 (HEAD -
Author: w3schools-test
Date:   Fri Mar 26 09:35:54 2021 +0100

    Updated index.html with a new line

commit 221ec6e10aeedbfd02b85264087cd9adc18e4b26
Author: w3schools-test
Date:   Fri Mar 26 09:13:07 2021 +0100

    First release of Hello World!
```

For a shorter view, use `git log --oneline`:

Example

```
[user@localhost] $ git log --oneline
09f4acd Updated index.html with a new line
221ec6e First release of Hello World!
```

To see which files changed in each commit, use `git log --stat`:

Example

```
[user@localhost] $ git log --stat
```

Drag and drop the correct flag to add a commit message.

```
git commit      "Initial commit"
```

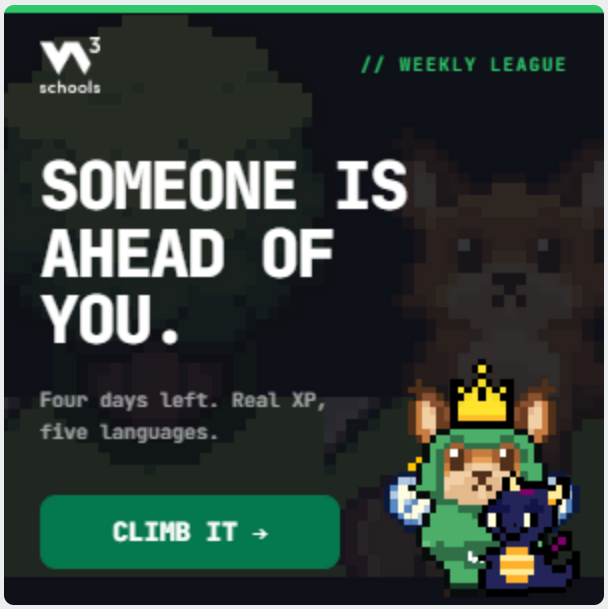
-a -m -s

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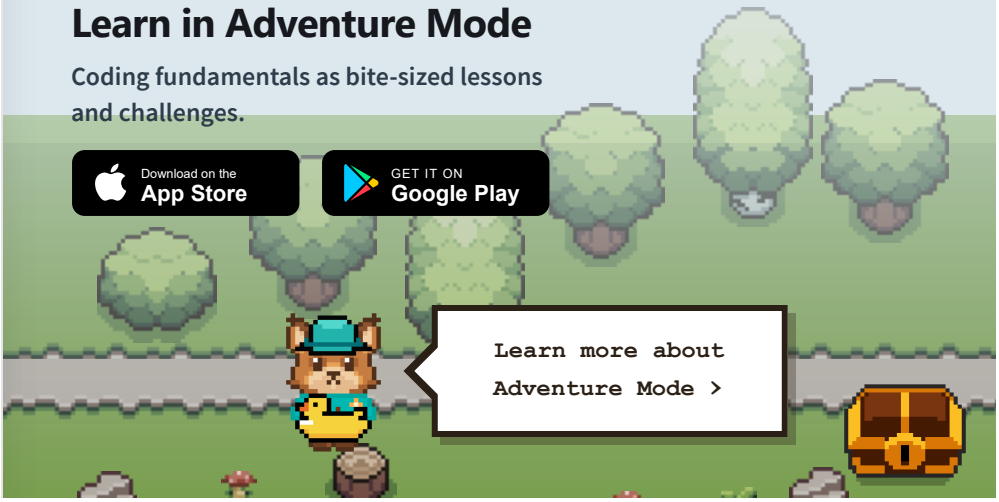
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